Outlook

Re: Events of August 29, 2024

From McCabe, Endreya (IHS/PHX) <Endreya.McCabe@ihs.gov>
Date Fri 30-Aug-24 12:41
To Turnage, Kevin D. (IHS/PHX) <Kevin.Turnage@ihs.gov>

Good afternoon Kevin,

Thank you for sharing with me. I concur with you on the legal aspects of not having proper policies. I also agree with you on ensuring that we have certified and qualified staff in oversight of radiology.

I understand your frustration with working through successfully ensuring we have compliance with our policies. I am concerned that things have reached the level of you feeling insecure about your job. Please know that I have full confidence in your abilities to perform your job and do not want you to feel as if you cannot move forward on making critical decisions to ensure compliance. I understand now your comment yesterday about not being able to work things out with Clint. I fully understand that your trust and confidence in him has been broken. I want to set a time next week to discuss this. Again thank you for trusting me and being fully transparent about how you're feeling.

Respectfully,
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From: "Turnage, Kevin D. (IHS/PHX)" <Kevin.Turnage@ihs.gov>
Subject: Events of August 29, 2024
Date: 30 August 2024 10:43
To: "McCabe, Endreya (IHS/PHX)" <Endreya.McCabe@ihs.gov>

Dear Dr. McCabe,

I wanted to update you on yesterday's activities for your situational awareness. Despite my commitment to our organization's mission and values, I find it increasingly difficult to continue working under the leadership of an individual who openly disregards essential patient safety protocols and legal requirements, often citing personal disagreement as the rationale for such actions.

Yesterday, I was informed that my efforts on the Policy Management Policy were rendered redundant, as Clinton Pope decided to rewrite the entire policy without any prior communication or explanation. He cited that I could not write the policy as he feels it needs to be done. Additionally, Mr. Pope is

dismissive and judgmental when others disagree with him, regardless of the evidence supporting their opinions. This behavior not only undermines collaborative efforts but also jeopardizes the psychological safety of the staff, creating an environment of inefficiencies and confusion within the team. In response, I have removed the team from the project and have deleted my drafts and copies, including all evidence-based materials.

Moreover, Mr. Pope's communication style often leaves me feeling frustrated and unheard. When my efforts to provide detailed information or solutions are dismissed as being too lengthy or not worth the time, I experience a deep sense of futility and frustration. The accusations of "jumping to conclusions" add to this frustration, making me feel unjustly criticized and belittled, especially when I believe I've made a reasoned and informed decision. This situation also creates a lot of confusion for me. I'm often left uncertain about what is expected of me in terms of communication and decision-making, which makes it difficult to know how to move forward. The mixed signals I receive about balancing thoroughness with brevity contribute to this confusion, leaving me unsure of how to communicate effectively.

Furthermore, Mr. Pope's dismissive, arrogant, contemptuous, and haughty demeanor exacerbates these challenges. These interactions make me feel personally rejected and isolated. When my communication is dismissed, it feels like my thoughts, ideas, and contributions are not valued. This leads to feelings of inadequacy and a growing sense of alienation from the team and Mr. Pope. Over time, I've begun to doubt my abilities, questioning my judgment and decision-making skills, which erodes my confidence. Anxiety is another significant impact of these interactions. I find myself anxious about future conversations with Mr. Pope, fearing more criticism or dismissal of my efforts. This constant worry creates performance anxiety, causing me to become overly cautious and second-guess my work. As a result, I've started to feel resentful, believing that my efforts to communicate or make decisions are not appreciated or respected.

This ongoing cycle of frustration, confusion, and anxiety has led to demotivation. I've lost a lot of my enthusiasm for my work, feeling that no matter what I do, it won't be good enough. The constant criticism and dismissal have made me feel embarrassed and self-conscious, especially if the feedback is given in front of others. Overall, these experiences have significantly impacted my well-being, work performance, and my relationship with Mr. Pope and the team.

This type of behavior is a form of harassment as the conduct is pervasive enough to create a work environment that a reasonable person would consider intimidating, hostile, and abusive. Additionally, this behavior clearly affects my ability to do my job effectively.

Brian Numkena, as stated by Ms. Holiday, does not have the required education or training to be the hospital RSO, which is what CQO and EHS was suggesting. Additionally, since he does not meet the requirements as outlined in federal and state law, he should also not be managing the dosimeter program. This oversight further complicates our compliance with federal and state regulations and compromises our commitment to maintaining the highest standards of safety.

I will continue to diligently review all suggested policy changes to ensure they are compliant with evidence-based materials, as well as federal and state laws, regulations, and standards. My commitment extends to maintaining strict adherence to legal requirements and upholding the highest levels of patient safety. This process is crucial to ensure that our practices not only meet regulatory demands but also embody the best practices in healthcare, thereby safeguarding the well-being of our patients and the integrity of our institution.

I hope this update helps in providing a comprehensive overview of the current situation. I am available for any further discussions or clarifications you may need.

Sincerely,

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"The single greatest impediment to error prevention in the medical industry is that we punish people for making mistakes." Dr. Lucian Leape

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